

Fearnleys Dry Bulk Market Outlook

Feb 26, 2026

SUMMARY AND OUTLOOK

In our previous update sent in January, we wrote:

We still see the same fundamental strength that led us to give the view that this year should be even stronger than in 2024. We think a higher average than 2022 (BDI 1933) is also likely, with the difference this year being higher average earnings for Capes/Newcs but lower for Kamsarmaxes down to Handysizes.

Factors on why we are bullish on 2026 market prospects:

- Global manufacturing is in expansion. This supports all commodity groups.*
- Industrial Metals prices have surged to the highest level since early 2022. These prices has correlated tightly with 1-year TC rates and second-hand values in the last 10 years.*
- Coal prices bottomed in April last year and have risen slowly since then. The coal futures curve structure is the most backwardated since the beginning of 2024.*
- Coal shipment volume growth turned positive at the end of last year after being deeply negative at the start of 2025. 5-year energy cycle repeating?*
- Iron ore shipment volume growth increased significantly during the second half of last year. The three-year cycle suggests strong growth until mid 2026, after which growth might start falling. Iron ore prices, spreads and curve structures look good, but its not “booming”.*
- Bauxite growth should continue due to continued Alumina smelter capacity additions in China. Growth likely to slow from last year’s pace, however.*
- Projections for the ECSAM grain season is to see higher volumes than last year.*
- All the above is likely to be strongly supported through most or all of this year by factors like relatively cheap oil prices, global interest rate cuts, high global credit growth and a weak US Dollar.*
- Regarding supply, total dwt additions are likely to end slightly lower than 3%. Ships having to go in for special survey this year will reduce the effective supply by between 0.5% and 1.0%.*

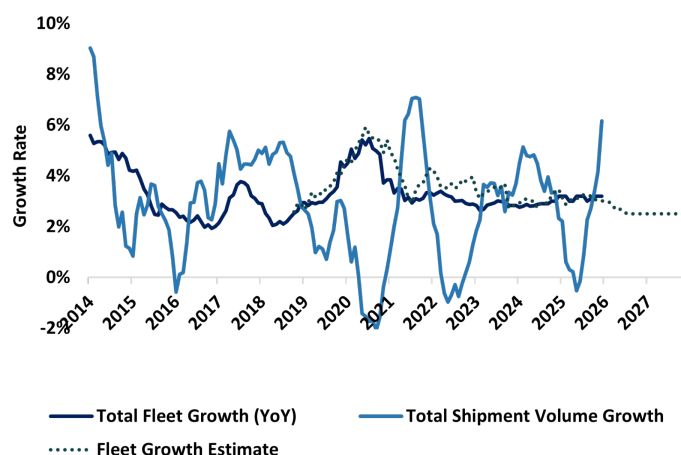
The year has started very strongly. The Jan/Feb average for Capes is the highest since 2010, whereas the mid and small-sized segments are averaging the highest since 2022. The mid and small-sized markets have risen through the Chinese New Year, which is highly unusual. Second-hand values have also started the year on a firm note. We see price increases in all segments and across most vintages.

We don’t see any significant changes to the bullish factors we listed in our previous report in January. Barring any black swans, it is extremely hard to see how March and Q2 markets will turn significantly lower than expected (similar, or lower levels than last year). In this regard, uncertainty is higher in Q3 and Q4, but the longer leading indicators we use strongly suggest 2026 will average higher than 2025 throughout the whole year. We still expect a cycle downturn in 2027.

Earnings Forecasts 26 and 27

Year	C5TC	P5TC	S11TC	HS7TC
2026	30-35 USD pd	16-20 USD pd	16-20 USD pd	13-16 USD pd
2027	20-25 USD pd	13-16 USD pd	13-16 USD pd	10-13 USD pd

Dry Bulk Shipment Volume Growth vs Supply Growth (All Segments)





Fleet Statistics (In Million DWT)

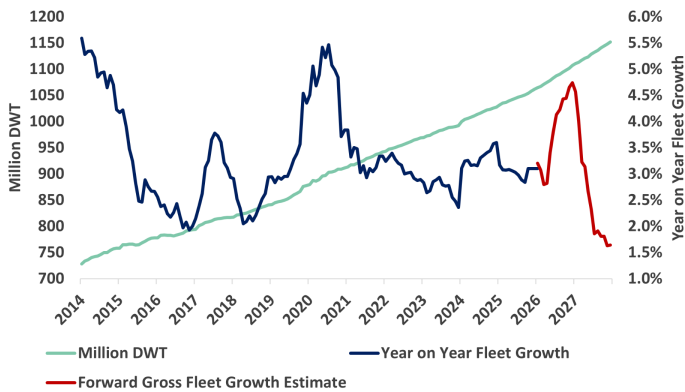
	Total Fleet	CapeNewc	Pmx/Kmx	Smx/Hmx	Handy
2025					
Deliveries	36	7.2	9.9	13.1	5.8
Scrapping	3.7	1	1.3	0.1	1.1
Fleet Growth	3.0%	1.9%	3.3%	5.2%	4.1%
2026 YTD					
Deliveries	8.1	1.4	2.8	2.5	1.4
Remaining on Schedule	45	9.5	15.2	12	5.5
Scrapping	0.5	0.2	0.2	0.1	0.4
YoY Fleet Growth (February)	3.1%	1.6%	2.7%	5.2%	3.0%



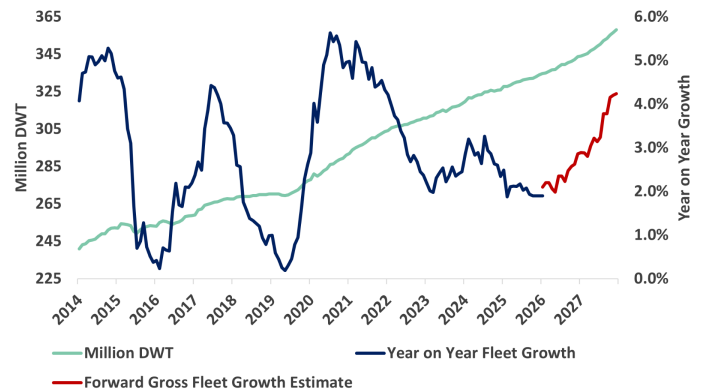


Fleet Growth and Forward Estimates (ex Scrapping and Delivery Delays or Cancellations)

Total Fleet Growth Including Estimate



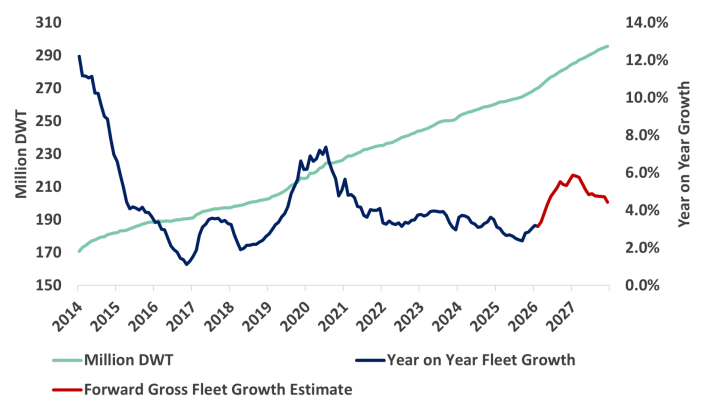
Cape/Newc Fleet Growth Including Estimate



VLOC Fleet Growth Including Estimate



Panamax/Kamsarmax Fleet Growth Including Estimate



Supramax/Ultramax Fleet Growth Including Estimate



Handysize Fleet Growth Including Estimate



PERIOD RATES AND ASSET VALUES

In our previous report, we wrote:

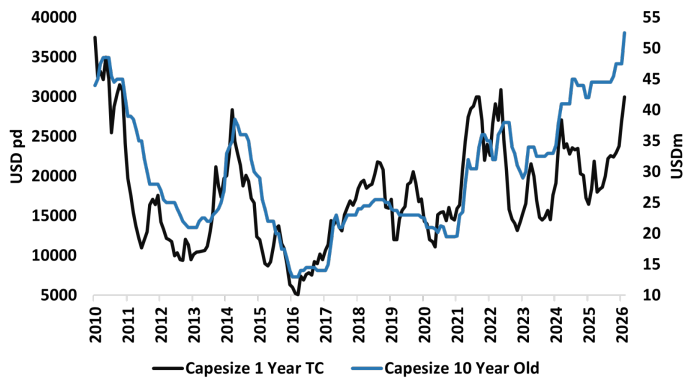
Since 2023, the correlation between 1-year time charter rates and secondhand values has dropped considerably compared with the 2010-2022 period.

All values remain high based on the 2010-2022 regime, but based on the 2023 onwards regime, values are now fair compared with 1-year TC rates. As outlined already in this report, we think 1-year TC rates are likely to surpass the 2024 highs this year. This suggests values could rise to the peak levels seen in 2024 or higher (for sub-Cape/Newcs).

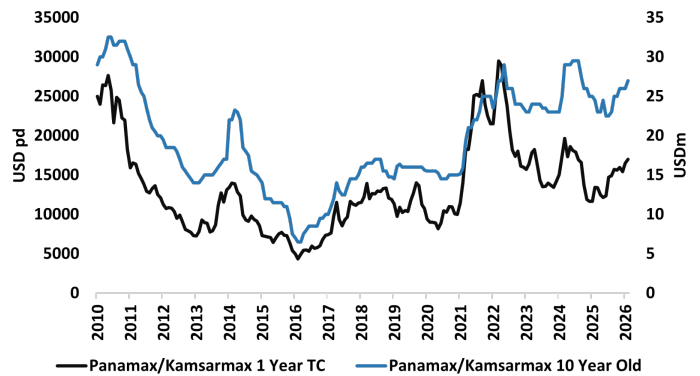
For Capes/Newcs, we expect values to be stable or rise slightly in the coming months.

Cape/Newc values have continued to climb, and are now at the highest since 2008. Sub Cape values are rising, with some vintages already at 2024 peak levels.

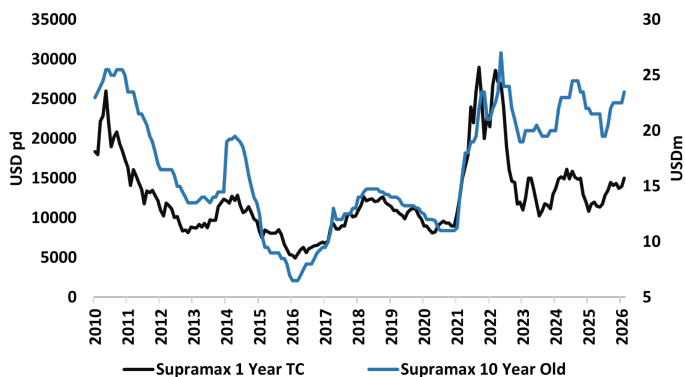
Capesize 1 Year TC vs Capesize 10 Year Old (Japanese)



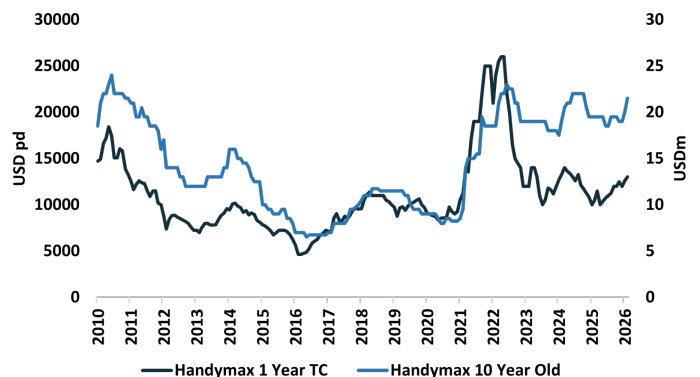
Panamax/Kamsarmax 1 Year TC vs Panamax/Kamsarmax 10 Year Old (Japanese)



Supramax 1 Year TC vs Supramax 10 Year Old (Japanese)



Handysize 1 Year TC vs Handysize 10 Year Old (Japanese)



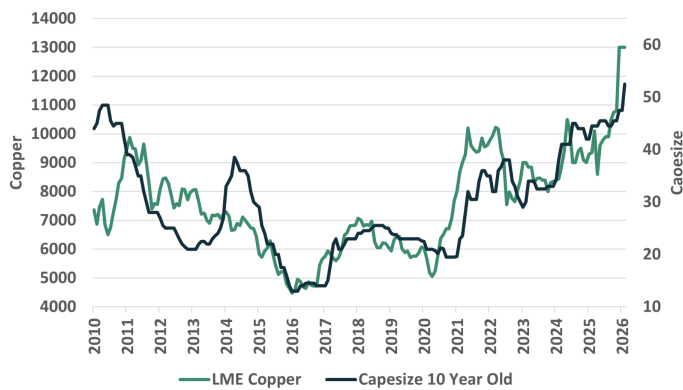
Asset Values vs Commodity Prices

In our previous report, we wrote:

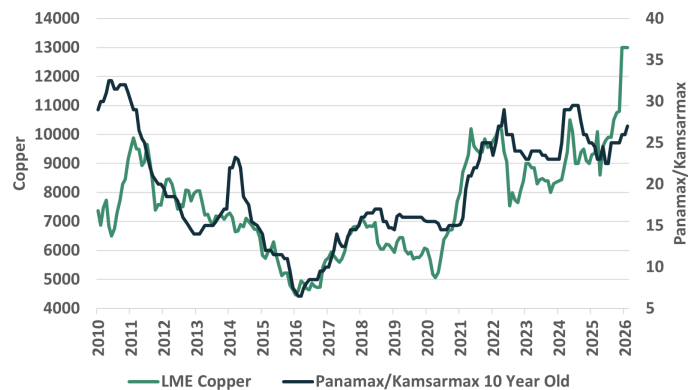
Industrial metal prices often precede the change in second-hand values by around six months. The charts below display the price of copper against second-hand values since 2014. The correlation is high because the price of copper is a barometer of industrial activity and also reflects inflationary or deflationary periods. The price of copper keeps surging and suggests second-hand values could climb significantly. Earnings are not there to support second-hand values rising like the price of copper is suggesting, however...

Capesize and Newcastlemax values keep rising, and are the only ones of all the segments that are matching the rise in copper. For the sub-Cape segments, earnings will have to rise further for values to rise like Capes/Newcs, in our opinion.

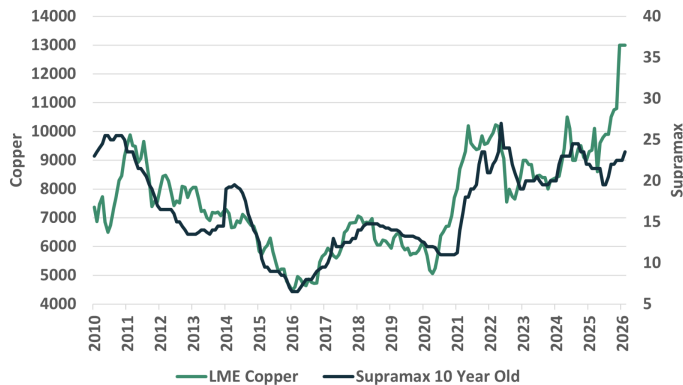
Copper Price vs Capesize 10 Year Old



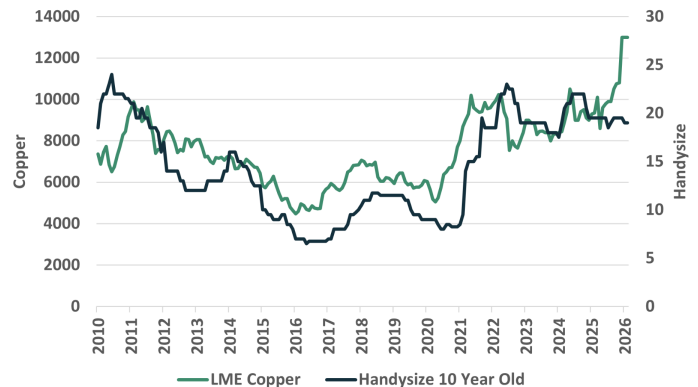
Copper Price vs Kamsarmax 10 Year Old



Copper Price vs Supramax 10 Year Old



Copper Price vs Handysize 10 Year Old



LME Copper Price vs Panamax/Kamsarmax NB Price



TRADE FLOWS YEAR ON YEAR GROWTH

	Iron Ore	Coal	Grains	Others	Total
Oct-24	-5%	5%	-5%	6%	1.6%
Nov-24	-1%	7%	1%	13%	5.5%
Dec-24	-4%	-1%	-15%	6%	-1.1%
Jan-25	-4%	-3%	-5%	11%	0.2%
Feb-25	-6%	-12%	-10%	9%	-4.1%
Mar-25	1%	-6%	-4%	14%	2.5%
Apr-25	1%	-6%	-6%	9%	1.1%
May-25	4%	-12%	1%	9%	0.3%
Jun-25	1%	-10%	-2%	8%	-0.8%
Jul-25	4%	2%	7%	12%	6.3%
Aug-25	5%	-2%	10%	5%	4.2%
Sep-25	4%	0%	20%	8%	5.2%
Oct-25	14%	-3%	-1%	4%	4.7%
Nov-25	6%	-3%	9%	7%	4.5%
Dec-25	12%	3%	21%	11%	9.9%
Jan-26	11%	-2%	14%	12%	9.6%

	100 - 220 KDWT	25 - 100 KDWT		Far East	India + MEG	Southeast Asia
Oct-24	-6%	7%	Oct-24	5%	-4%	20%
Nov-24	6%	7%	Nov-24	2%	-10%	14%
Dec-24	-5%	1%	Dec-24	6%	-1%	10%
Jan-25	-2%	2%	Jan-25	-8%	13%	12%
Feb-25	-7%	-2%	Feb-25	-10%	0%	9%
Mar-25	-2%	5%	Mar-25	-7%	-1%	11%
Apr-25	-1%	0%	Apr-25	-1%	5%	5%
May-25	1%	0%	May-25	-2%	4%	3%
Jun-25	-2%	0%	Jun-25	-1%	6%	6%
Jul-25	3%	7%	Jul-25	-1%	9%	-4%
Aug-25	-1%	6%	Aug-25	4%	10%	1%
Sep-25	4%	7%	Sep-25	8%	19%	-1%
Oct-25	14%	0%	Oct-25	0%	6%	6%
Nov-25	-1%	7%	Nov-25	3%	16%	0%
Dec-25	12%	8%	Dec-25	6%	4%	6%
Jan-26	12%	9%	Jan-26	10%	2%	9%



MACRO ECONOMIC OUTLOOK

This page gives brief comments on what the charts on the next page tells us.

Top left chart:

The BDI year-on-year change has moved into positive territory in the last months. As usual, lagging behind credit growth in China.

The credit growth rate have dipped noticeably in December and January. Should this continue it will be a bearish signal for 2027 market prospects.

Top right chart:

Except for a decoupling in 2024, the change in bond yields in China and the US has been a good leading indicator for dry bulk demand growth. Strong support for demand growth in 2026 is suggested, but also a potential peak.

Middle left chart:

Lower crude oil prices are bullish for economic growth, and vice versa. The chart displays that since 2017, there has been a tight correlation between lower year-on-year oil prices and a higher year-on-year BDI, with the oil price change leading by 1 year.

Cheaper oil prices suggest the BDI could remain positive year-on-year throughout all of 2026.

Middle right chart:

Lower global interest rates strongly suggest 1-year TC rates could continue rising from here, and be above last year's levels throughout this year. Tentative signs of a peak in early 2027, however,

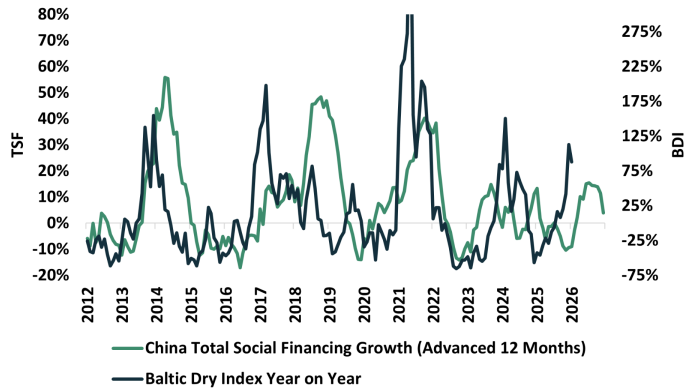
Bottom left chart:

The OECD Diffusion index correlation with the BDI is very high, as usual. The OECD index momentum is strong, which suggest the BDI year on year change will remain positive in the next 6 months. Worth noting is that the current OECD Diffusion index level of 18 is close to the maximum. This could mean the cycle top will be this year.

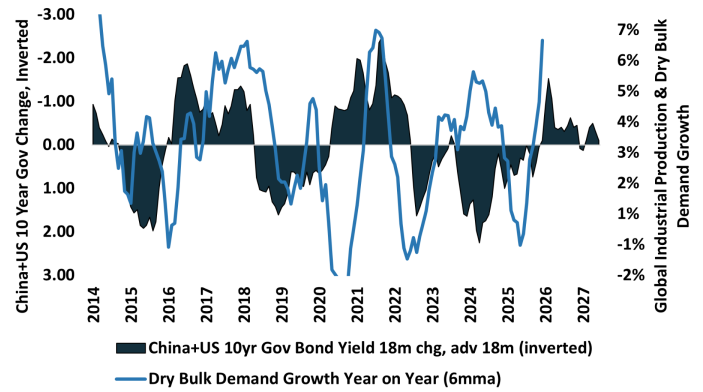
Bottom right chart:

The dollar index has weakened in the last months, and as usual, the result is increased dry bulk shipment volume growth, with a few months' lag. The dollar index suggests total dry bulk shipment volume growth will remain around current levels.

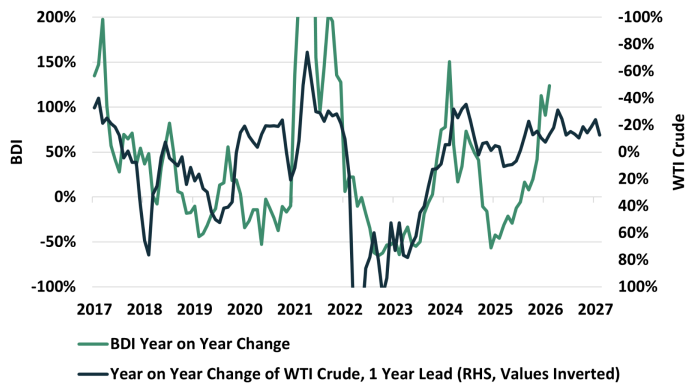
Baltic Dry Index Year on Year Change vs China Credit Growth (12 Months Lead)



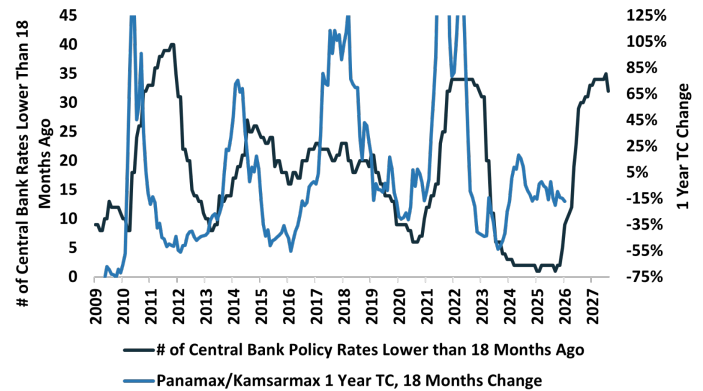
China + US Gov Bond Yield Change, 18 Months Lead. vs Dry Bulk Demand Growth



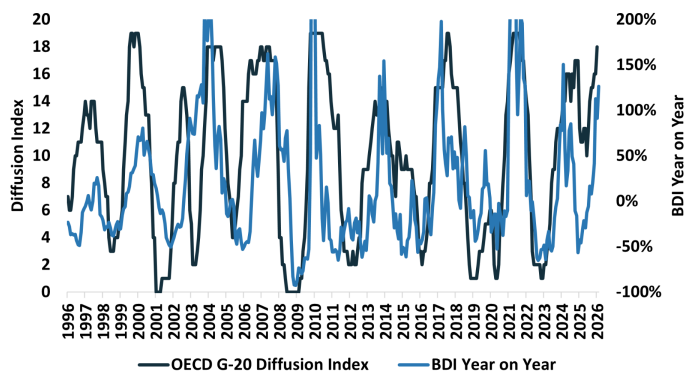
WTI Crude Oil Price YoY, 1 Year Lead vs BDI YoY



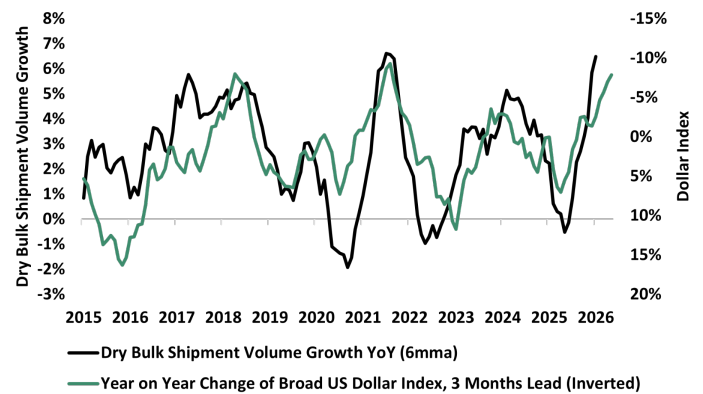
of Central Bank Rates Lower than 18 Months Ago, vs Pmx/Kmx 1 Year TC 18 Months Change



OECD G-20 Diffusion Index vs BDI YoY



Broad US Dollar Index Year on Year vs Dry Bulk Shipment Volume Growth





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